University of St. Thomas
AI ETHICS Fall 2026
SEIS 651-02
Midterm Examination

Issued October 15, 2026
Written Portion Due October 22, 2026, at 5:00pm CDT on Canvas
Verbal Portion will Take Place on October 22, 2026 in class.

Please read this entire document prior to starting.

A. Overview

Your midterm examination consists of two parts, a written and verbal portion.

- You will first do the written portion and turn it in by **October 22, 2026**, by 5:00 PM CDT.
- You will participate in the verbal portion in class on **October 22, 2026**.

The verbal portion of the midterm is dependent on the written portion. This means that if no written portion is submitted by the deadline, then the verbal portion will not be graded.

The written portion of the midterm will be done independently, out of class, and must be submitted by the due date. The written portion will be worth 100 points.

The verbal portion of the midterm will involve small group discussions with your classmates. There will be three rounds of group discussion. You will be given an observation form to note your observations from your conversations. This observation form will be submitted at the end of the class session. The verbal portion, dependent on the submission of your observation form, is worth 100 points. The observation form will be provided in class after the written portion has been submitted.

To give you an idea about the format of the verbal portion it will be organized as follows:

Round 1: You will be paired with a classmate and will discuss your midterm experience with them. At the completion of Round 1 you will be provided with a link to a discussion board to answer the following questions:

1) What did I share about my experience?

2) What did I learn about my classmate's experience?

Round 2: You will be placed into small groups consisting of everyone who answered the same midterm exam prompt. In this discussion you will spend time talking about your responses. At the completion of Round 2 you will be provided with a link to a discussion board to post three key themes that you saw emerge through the

discussion. Your group will need to decide whether to report out as a group or individually in Round 3.

Round 3: The entire class will reassemble, and each group will report out either collectively or individually. Once all groups have presented, each group will be asked at least 3 questions by members of other class groups before the third round will conclude.

B. Written Portion of Midterm Examination

Directions: Below there are four exam prompts for your consideration. Choose **one** of these **four** to respond. Responding to more than one will not earn you extra credit. If more than one is turned in, only the first will be graded. The response to this prompt is worth 100 points.

Your midterm exam must:

- Follow course formatting guidelines
    - Have 1" margins
    - Use 12 point font
    - Use 1.5 line spacing
    - Have First and Last Name, AI Ethics SEIS 651-02, Document Title, Date, and Page Number on the top of each page
    - Use APA formatting citation and referencing
- Minimum of 2 pages, maximum of 4 pages in length.
- Must be in PDF format

THE STANDARDIZATION OF FORMATTING IS REQUIRED SO THAT ALL STUDENT SUBMISSIONS LOOK THE SAME. FAILURE TO ADHERE TO THESE FORMATTING REQUIREMENTS WILL RESULT IN YOUR MIDTERM EXAM NOT BEING GRADED.

PLEASE NOTE, ANY RESPONSE LONGER THAN 4 PAGES WILL ONLY HAVE THE FIRST FOUR PAGES OF THE RESPONSE GRADED.

Midterm responses need to be submitted online on Canvas in the submission center module (right after the syllabus and reference module and before the Week 1 module.)

You will be asked to sign a statement of authenticity in Canvas at time of submission that all final wording is your own and any use of the ideas of others is properly quoted and cited. Students who do not sign and submit this assurance affirmed with statements marked "TRUE" **will not have** their midterm scored.

==========***Exam Prompts***==========

Review directions and formatting requirements outlined above.

1) What is one belief or opinion related to AI ethics that you held before taking this class that you are now reexamining as a result of the course material and/or interaction with your classmates? Discuss:

    a. What inspired you to reconsider or examine your belief, and why?

    b. Did your opinion/belief ultimately change?

2) Your company is implementing a policy around the responsible use of AI technology. As this policy is being rolled out, a project is about to start that may be affected by the new policy. Review both the policy definition and project description and answer the following:

    Based on your company's definition of AI, and the description answer the following:

    a. Would this workbook be considered an "AI system"? Why or why not?
    b. Would this workbook (and everyone who uses it) be required to comply with your company's responsible AI policy? Why or why not?

    Policy Definition: "For the purposes of this policy, AI is defined as a machine-based system that can, for a given set of human-defined objectives, make predictions, recommendations, or decisions influencing real or virtual environments. Artificial intelligence systems use machine- and human-based inputs to perceive real and virtual environments; abstract such perceptions into models through analysis in an automated manner; and use model inference to formulate options for information or action. The definition includes but is not limited to systems that use machine learning, large language model, natural language processing, and computer vision technologies, including generative AI.2 The definition does not include basic calculations, basic automation, or pre-recorded "if

this then that (IFTT)" response systems."

Description of Project: Your company is looking to predict the employee attrition rate for the next 5 years. Your coworker has written a macro in an Excel workbook to divide the company's past employee hiring and attrition data into subsets by tenure and managerial level (placing each subset in its own worksheet), add a line chart with historical attrition rates for each subset of data, and then predict the next 5 years of attrition rates using a formula based on the average historical attrition rate. Once the macro is executed, it requires no further human intervention to generate these charts and predictions.

3) In class, we discussed the black box problem and explainability in AI. Drawing from the lecture material, class discussions, and your own perspective and experience, discuss the extent and intersections of 1) corporate, 2) developer, **and** 3) consumer responsibility in the creation, release, and use of black box AI tools?

4) A hospital management company that runs several hospitals throughout the State of Kansas is considering the use of ChatGPT to construct discharge instructions for all patients. You are serving on a team of consultants working for the University of St. Thomas who has been retained by this hospital system for assistance with implementation of AI. As the AI ethics subject matter expert of the team, what considerations should the consulting group present to the healthcare system?